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Spotlight ● FOLLOW-UP

Lawmakers demand nursing home details

Criticize Healey administration over lax enforcement, rubber-stamping deals

By Kay Lazar
and Neena Hagen
GLOBE STAFF

Massachusetts legislators who have spent years seeking stronger nursing home oversight are de-

manding that the Healey administration explain why it keeps awarding new licenses to operators with poor track records.

“It’s depressing and scandalous,” said Senator Patricia Jehlen, a

Somerville Democrat, following a Boston Globe Spotlight Team report about out-of-state operators, many with troubling records, acquiring nearly one of every five homes in Massachusetts.

That report focused on 12 licenses handed to Eli Mirlis of New Jersey, chief executive of RegalCare, who aggressively cut spending at

his homes even as he transferred growing sums of nursing home funds into his related real estate and management companies. His homes in Taunton and Quincy went from five-star ratings to one-star a few years after he purchased them, according to federal assessments.

The story also looked at eight

NURSING HOMES, Page A7

SJC will review ICE arrests of defendants

Questions of jurisdiction complicate efforts by state to hold criminal trials

By Sean Cotter
GLOBE STAFF

The Trump administration’s aggressive deportation push is supposed to focus on “the worst of the worst,” immigrants with serious criminal records. Yet for dozens of immigrants facing criminal charges in Massachusetts, their arrest by federal immigration officials has unleashed chaos and confusion, leaving judges and lawyers grappling with a tangled web of open warrants and unanswerable charges.

The thorny issues raised by such cases land before the state’s highest court on Monday, as justices consider whether state district court judges can order US Immigration and Customs Enforcement to make detainees available for trial after they’ve been sent out of state, and what Massachusetts judges should do if ICE won’t let them show up.

The Supreme Judicial Court’s ruling will have sweeping consequences for how the Massachusetts criminal justice system interacts with the Trump administration’s federal immigration apparatus. A ruling, however, won’t come for a few months.

ICE is not legally required to follow orders issued by state courts, as Massachusetts judges have no jurisdiction over the agency. But state actions in criminal cases can alter immigration proceedings; if charges go away, so can the federal government’s reason for holding someone without bond.

“Normally, state actors don’t have the ability to directly affect federal immigration enforcement,” said David Rassoul Rangaviz, an attorney for a

COURT CASES, Page A6

At crossroads of privacy, protection

Some in policing resist halting Flock surveillance

By Yogev Toby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

By the time New Bedford city councilors learned their police had installed license plate cameras from Flock Safety — two years after the fact — the system had already been abused.

Two officers had searched records of their ex-romantic partners hundreds of times. Other police departments from around the country had searched the New Bedford database without needing warrants and with few checks on whether any of them were justified or properly done. The cameras had been up for two years with no notification, much less debate among the public.

Residents and some city officials were livid. “This technology has been running rampant without safeguards for the past two years,” New Bedford City Councilor Shane Burgo said at a Sept. 24 council meeting, where he presented an ordinance that would require police to obtain warrants for all searches and restrict record-sharing with other law enforcement. In the interim, the ordinance would ban all such cameras until guardrails are in place.

Similar backlashes against the technology have unfolded across the country in recent months, in part because of abuses by police officers similar to those in New Bedford, but also because in many cases they were installed under wraps, with little public notification.

SURVEILLANCE, Page A10

►How the technology works. D1.



MELECK ELDAHSHOURY FOR THE BOSTON GLOBE

Caitlin Fontecchio and her son, Vincent, in their Worcester home. The family has been hit hard by rising mortgage rates.

AS MORTGAGE RATES CLIMB, HOUSING CRISIS DEEPENS

Surge could add hundreds of dollars monthly, squeezing buyers

By Andrew Brinker
GLOBE STAFF

What Caitlin Fontecchio and her family have been attempting to pull off this year — selling their home in Worcester to buy a bigger, newly built house in nearby Warren — was already a delicate balancing act.

Then the global economy tipped the scales against her. After steadily declining for more than a year, mortgage rates have soared in recent months, particularly in September, as the average on a 30-year fixed-rate mortgage is now at nearly 7.3 percent — the highest since 2023. The surge is adding potentially \$1,000 to a monthly payment for a typical home purchase in Greater Boston.

It’s a huge financial blow to prospective home buyers across Eastern Massachusetts. And suddenly, no one is coming to see Fontecchio’s home in Worcester. Two open

MORTGAGES, Page A7

Rising mortgage rates are pushing up monthly payments

Monthly mortgage payment on the median-priced house in Greater Boston.



Chart: ANDREW BRINKER AND CHRISTINA PRIGNANO/GLOBE STAFF • Source: Freddie Mac Primary Mortgage Market Survey, Greater Boston Association of Realtors, Bankrate Mortgage Calculator

City abandons longer center bus lane for Columbus Ave.

By Diti Kohli
GLOBE STAFF

Since its debut five years ago, the center-running bus lane on Columbus Avenue in Roxbury has been lauded by Mayor Michelle Wu and the MBTA, who say the project helped speed up bus travel and slow cars.

But officials have scrapped longstanding plans to extend it by another mile in favor of a more traditional curb-hugging design, pivoting away from a concept that has caused an uproar in other closely watched transit projects, including along Blue Hill Avenue.

The Wu administration and the T altered the latest design for Columbus Avenue to instead include side-running bus lanes in both directions between Jackson Square and Ruggles Station, said Boston’s interim Chief of Streets

BUS LANES, Page A10



MATTHEW J. LEE/GLOBE STAFF

PATRIOTS STUFF BILLS

Offensive lineman Jared Wilson celebrated after teammate Efton Chisim III hauled in a touchdown reception late in the game as the New England Patriots upset the division-leading Bills in Buffalo, 29-26. **C1.**

Breezy to please

Monday: Windy, sun late. High 65-70, low 44-49.

Tuesday: More sun. High 60-65, low 43-48.

Weather and comics, **D4-5.**
Obituaries, **B6.**

For the family and friends of Owen Coyne, the three sport star athlete from Marblehead, his legacy will be one of greatness on the field and humility off it. **C1.**

The Coast Guard suspended its search for six passengers on-

board a medical transport flight that vanished while en route from Bermuda to Boston. **B1.**

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